

Gladius

\$GLAD

Catena vinciens libertatem, aequalitatem, humanitatem

"The chain that binds liberty, equality, and humanity"

I PREAMBLE

Preamble

In 450 BC, Rome inscribed its laws on twelve bronze tablets and placed them in the Forum for all to see. For the first time, law belonged to everyone — not just the powerful. Citizens could read the rules that governed them, challenge their application, and demand accountability from those who wielded authority. Law became public. Justice became legible.

Twenty-five centuries later, we find ourselves in a new Forum — a global, digital public square in which capital flows freely across borders, yet largely without moral accountability. Markets reward profit. They are indifferent to the means by which it is obtained. Entities that undermine democratic institutions, exploit labor, pollute the commons, or suppress human rights operate within the same financial system as those who do not.

Gladius is a response to this indifference. Named not for the gladius as a weapon of conquest, but as the sword of justice — the instrument carried by Iustitia herself — Gladius is a blockchain token built on Algorand, a carbon-negative, energy-efficient network whose very architecture reflects the environmental values of this community. It directs capital and community toward entities that demonstrably uphold the Universal Declaration of Human Rights. It is a signal, a standard, and a civic commitment inscribed on an immutable public ledger.

Money is not neutral. Where capital flows is a moral choice. Gladius makes that choice visible.

II FUNDAMENTO

Fundamento — The Foundation

Gladius rests on a single foundational document: the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, adopted by the United Nations General Assembly on 10 December 1948, and endorsed by 193 member states. The UDHR represents the broadest possible international consensus on what it means to treat human beings with dignity.

It is not a partisan document. It predates the polarizations of contemporary politics. It speaks in the language of human dignity rather than ideology. For this reason it is uniquely suited to serve as the constitutional text of Gladius — a standard that transcends borders, cultures, and political systems.

The UDHR serves as the *Lex Gladii* — the founding law of our community. All ethical criteria, verification standards, and governance decisions shall be grounded in and traceable to its articles.

III LEX GLADII

Lex Gladii — The Ethical Criteria

The following criteria, derived directly from the UDHR, define what it means to hold *Civitas* status within the Gladius community. Entities — whether companies, organizations, or individuals — are assessed against these standards continuously and transparently.

Article	Criterion	Category
Art. 19	Freedom of expression upheld — no suppression of employees, users, or public discourse	Democracy
Art. 20	Freedom of association respected — no suppression of unions or collective organization	Labor
Art. 21	Democratic participation supported — no active undermining of democratic institutions or electoral processes	Democracy
Art. 26 ♦	Education upheld as a fundamental right — entities support access to independent education and the universitas: the full breadth of human knowledge, including universities and research institutions free from political or commercial capture	Democracy
Art. 27 ♦	Independent culture and art supported — no suppression, capture, or instrumentalization of cultural expression for political or commercial ends	Democracy
Art. 23	Fair labor practices — living wages, safe conditions, no forced or child labor	Labor
Art. 25	Environmental responsibility — commitment to clean and renewable energy, minimizing harm to the shared commons	Environment
Art. 12	Privacy respected — no unlawful surveillance or exploitation of personal data	Rights
Art. 17	Property rights upheld — no predatory or fraudulent financial practices	Finance

Article	Criterion	Category
Art. 29 ♦	Duties to the community recognized — tolerance of the rights of others ends precisely where the freedoms of others begin. Gladius does not extend Civitas to entities that actively work to undermine the rights and freedoms upon which this community is founded	Rights
Art. 18 ♦	Freedom of religion and freedom from religion equally upheld. For entities known to further a religious or ideological agenda, the sole ethical criterion is demonstrable charitable benefit to the broader community.	Rights

♦ Added in Draft II Highlighted rows indicate new criteria

This list is not exhaustive and will evolve through *Comitia* governance as the community grows and as new challenges emerge. The Lex Gladii is a living document, reviewed annually.

IV DE CIVITATE

De Civitate — On Citizenship

Any entity — company, organization, or individual — may apply for *Civitas* status: formal recognition as an ethical actor within the Gladius community. Civitas is not purchased. It is earned through demonstrated adherence to the Lex Gladii and maintained through ongoing transparency.

A *Dignitas* score — a continuous, publicly auditable ethical rating — is assigned to each Civis and updated as new information becomes available. Dignitas is not a binary pass/fail but a graduated measure that reflects the complexity of operating ethically in the real world. Entities with higher Dignitas receive greater access to Gladius ecosystem benefits.

Civitas status is subject to a formal three-stage disciplinary process, initiated when credible evidence of UDHR violations emerges. All proceedings are public, evidence-based, and subject to review by the Council.

Stage	Term	Meaning
I	<i>Monitio</i>	A formal warning is issued. The entity is given a defined period to address the identified violation and provide a remediation plan.
II	<i>Suspensio</i>	Partial or full temporary suspension of Civitas status and associated ecosystem benefits, for a defined period determined by the Council.
III	<i>Expulsio</i>	Permanent barring from the Gladius ecosystem. Reserved for the most serious or repeated violations. Requires a supermajority Council decision.

V DE IUSTITIA

De Iustitia — On Verification

The integrity of Gladius depends entirely on the credibility of its verification. We reject self-certification. We require independent, continuous, and transparent assessment.

Gladius employs AI-powered verification as its primary layer — processing public data sources including regulatory filings, news, ESG disclosures, labor records, energy certifications, and civil society reporting — to maintain a living assessment of each Civis entity. AI verification offers consistency, scalability, and resistance to the lobbying and capture that afflicts human-only committees.

Crucially, AI verification operates with full transparency: every Dignitas score is accompanied by auditable reasoning — the specific sources, signals, and UDHR articles that informed it. No score is issued without explanation.

Where AI assessment is contested, ambiguous, or involves novel ethical terrain, matters are escalated to the Council for human deliberation. The Council does not replace AI verification — it supervises it.

*Iustitia is blindfolded not because she ignores evidence, but because she weighs it without favor.
Our AI layer is her blindfold — consistent, impartial, and always accountable to the Lex.*

VI DE CONSILIO

De Consilio — The Council

The Council is the human oversight layer of Gladius — seven members of recognized expertise in human rights, environmental governance, labor law, technology ethics, and democratic theory. Council members are elected by the Gladius community through the *Comitia* and serve fixed, non-renewable terms of three years to preserve full independence from political and financial influence.

A dedicated *Quaestor* — responsible for financial custodianship and the integrity of the community treasury — may serve beyond the standard three year term where continuity is in the practical interest of the community. This mandate is subject to periodic renewal by the *Comitia*.

The Council holds the following powers: review and override of AI verification decisions upon petition; interpretation of the Lex Gladii in novel cases; supervision of the AI verification system itself; and the final word in all disciplinary proceedings including *Expulsio*, which requires a supermajority decision. The Council may not unilaterally amend the Lex Gladii — that power belongs to the *Comitia* alone.

All Council deliberations are conducted publicly and recorded on-chain. There are no closed sessions.

VII DE COMITIA

De Comitia — On Governance

The *Comitia* is the democratic assembly of Gladius — the mechanism by which \$GLAD holders participate in the governance of the protocol. It embodies the Roman principle that law belongs to the people, and that those who are governed must have a voice in how they are governed.

\$GLAD holders may propose and vote on: amendments to the Lex Gladii; election of Council members; allocation of the community treasury; updates to the verification methodology; and any other matter affecting the Gladius protocol. Voting power is proportional to \$GLAD holdings, subject to anti-concentration measures designed to prevent capture by large actors.

A minimum quorum and supermajority threshold apply to amendments of the foundational Lex Gladii, ensuring that core ethical commitments cannot be eroded by simple majority or low-participation votes.

VIII DE GLADIO

De Gladio — The Token

\$GLAD is the native token of the Gladius ecosystem, built on Algorand — a carbon-negative, pure proof-of-stake blockchain whose energy efficiency and environmental credentials are themselves an expression of the values of this community. It is not primarily a speculative instrument — it is a civic signal. Holding \$GLAD is a public declaration of alignment with the values of the Lex Gladii.

\$GLAD has the following utilities: governance participation through the *Comitia*; access to preferential DeFi pools composed exclusively of Civitas-certified entities; a medium of exchange within the Gladius ecosystem; and a reputational signal recognized by participating organizations and communities.

Token distribution shall be designed to reward early community builders, verified Civitas entities, Council members, and long-term holders — while discouraging purely extractive participation. Detailed tokenomics will be published in a companion technical document.

\$GLAD is not a bet on price. It is a bet on the possibility that capital, community, and conscience can move together.